

14. Martius, im Jahre 1742

Dear Wilhelm,

Your letter arrived Tuesday and I have read it three times, chiefly because I could hear you preening through the ink. A repaired road, an honest butcher, the Bürgermeister shaking your hand in the square — you built the town a clock and it has thanked you by becoming respectable. I am delighted for you, old friend, and not at all surprised. You never could make a thing that worked only as well as it needed to.

I am glad of the news, though I wonder how much of it your clock can rightly claim. Fevers pass and roads get mended, even without a marvel ticking over them. But I know better than to argue with you about measurements. You counted the stones of my garden path the summer you stayed with us, and informed me that two were loose. If you say the thing is perfect, then it is perfect.

As for the woodcarver and his identical chairs — Wilhelm, you are making too much of a clock. A man may find his best pattern late in life and be content to repeat it. Not every regularity in the world is your doing. It is a fine tower and an honest one, and I will not have you inventing troubles to deprive yourself of a triumph.

The winter here has been long and my knees are keeping the score. Write to me when the spring fairs open. I should like to see this marvel of yours with my own eyes before you find something in it to worry about. You always do.

Your friend,

Kohler

19. Aprilis 1742

I sat with Frau Messer at the inn this evening. She poured two glasses of wine, one for me and one for herself, and both were filled to exactly the same line. She did not measure. Her hand simply stopped at the same point.

We talked for an hour. She told me about her daughter's wedding preparations. Every detail was in order. The flowers chosen, the menu set, the linens measured. She listed it all with great satisfaction. I asked her if she was happy about the wedding. She said of course. I asked her what she liked best about the young man. She paused for a very long time. Then she said he was punctual.

On the walk home the stars were out. I tried to find the Huntsman, but the stars seemed evenly spaced. I am sure this was my imagination.

— W.L.

I disconnected the Gear at half past two yesterday afternoon. The procedure was as follows:

First, I disengaged the main coupling between the Gear and the tower's primary escapement. This required removal of the three anchor bolts (9/16 wrench, counter-clockwise, forty turns each). Second, I lifted the Gear from the drive shaft using the ceiling hoist. Third, I severed the harmonic linkage by cutting the resonance wire at both terminal points. The wire resisted ordinary shears. I used the heavy cutters from the bottom drawer.

The tower stopped at 2:47. The silence was immediate and complete. I had not realized how loud it was until it was gone.

I wrapped the Gear in oilcloth and returned it to its crate. It still hums. I do not know how to make it stop doing that.

Renner came to the tower this morning with a chair he had made. It was lopsided and ugly and he was grinning like a fool. He said he did not know why he'd come, only that he wanted me to see it.

- W.L.

DELIVERY MANIFEST

MODRON COLLECTIVE — PLANAR COURIER DIVISION

Ref: M-7742-5 • Tridrone Courier Class III • Priority: Standard



RECIPIENT: Wilhelm Zeiger, Uhrmacher, Kuckucksuhrturn, Tiefenwald

ORIGINATING PLANE: Mechanus, Foundries of Regulus

COURIERS: Tridrone Unit T-0331, T-0332, T-0333

CRATE DIMENSIONS: 3.1 × 3.1 × 3.1 cubits (cubic, within ±0.0002 cubit tolerance)

*Confirmed – 11 measurements,
all identical.*

QTY	ITEM	SERIAL	CONDITION
1	Cross-Planar Regulation Gear, adamantine-law alloy, 2.7 cubit dia., 0.4 cubit thickness	Ω-CVX-0091	Nominal
1	Calibration resonance wire, 4.2 cubits, copper-planar composite	Ω-CVX-0091-w	Nominal
3	Anchor bolt, Mechanus-grade steel, 9/16 thread	—	Nominal
1	Installation guide (Modron Standard Technical Document, 74 pp.)	—	Nominal

PACKING MATERIAL: Straw (parallel arrangement, Mechanus standard)

INSPECTION STATUS: All items verified. Zero defects. Zero variance.

Contents are property of the Modron Collective per Contract of Planar Accord M-7742§. Recipient is granted license of use, not ownership. Unauthorized modification, disassembly, or aesthetic embellishment constitutes breach. The Collective assumes no liability for harmonic resonance, ambient humming, or localized temporal effects in the vicinity of the Gear. Report discrepancies to your assigned Quadrone technical advisor within fourteen (14) standard days. No returns.

*The alloy shifts color in light. I
have no word for it.*

Nor would I.

COURIER (T-0331)

RECIPIENT

*The couriers came up the forest road in
perfect step. Brauer's geese followed them
the whole way. The couriers did not
acknowledge the geese.*

*The Quadrone answers only what
is asked. Nothing more. I find
this deeply refreshing.*